



11-14-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QZ4gzM7hwHk
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Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Education Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 14, 2023

Location: MCS Board Room

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate committee work session was held immediately prior to the regular meeting call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by Board President Williams, opening with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance led by student representatives [00:03:36](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mr. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, and President Williams.

- **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** A moment of silence was observed, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by student volunteers [00:03:36](#). Student groups from Westview Elementary also performed a musical parody celebrating the Middle Ages and their curriculum [00:08:59](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Standard consent agenda items, including prior meeting minutes, were reviewed and approved [00:36:53](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:14:02](#) Westview Elementary School Operational & Academic Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Ambler, Principal, along with Assistant Principal Mrs. Marlette.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Ambler presented an update on Westview Elementary, noting enrollment has reached nearly 500 students. The school maintains a 93% teacher retention rate, low attrition, and a 93%+ student attendance rate. Highlights included positive partnerships with Ball State University (tutoring, math methods, student teachers, and pre-service observations), the Westview Community Association (WVCA / PTO), and Westminster Presbyterian Church. Additionally, construction updates indicate that building additions<U+2014>including new classrooms, a Project Lead the Way science room, a teacher work/break room, an expanded nurse<U+2019>s clinic, and conference spaces<U+2014>remain on schedule for completion by late December. A life-skills special education classroom is slated to open in January.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal board action required.

[00:37:22](#) October Financial Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome reported an October student enrollment count of 4,951. Revised state basic grant revenues are estimated at approximately \$44.6 million. The Education Fund is expected to maintain a surplus position at year-end. The total checkbook cash balance stood at slightly over \$31.5 million at the end of October. The state school loan balance has been reduced to \$10 million (down from an original \$12 million), paid via monthly deductions from state basic grants per the amortization

schedule. Local property tax distributions from the county (\$4 to \$5 million) are anticipated in November and December.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:39:18](#).

[00:39:30](#) Financial End-of-Year Process & Rainy Day Fund Transfer Requests

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome requested board authorization to execute standard year-end line-item transfers to ensure account balances balance by December 31, without exceeding overall fund appropriations. Additionally, a companion request was made to authorize the transfer of up to \$3 million in unobligated surplus funds (from the Education Fund or other district surplus funds) into the Rainy Day Fund by the end of 2023.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:40:40](#).

[00:40:58](#) Administrator Compensation Package

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Chief Financial Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented proposals for the 2023<U+2013>24 administrator salary schedule, retroactive to July 1, 2023, covering central office administrators, building principals, assistant principals, and support administrators. Proposed raises range between \$4,000 (for administrators evaluated as effective) and \$6,000 (for those evaluated as highly effective), developed in coordination with the compensation committee and verified as financially prudent within current budget parameters.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:44:00](#).

[00:44:14](#) Public Hearing: Additional Appropriations (Rainy Day & Education Funds)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer / President Williams.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Following authorization to advertise at the previous meeting, President Williams formally opened a public hearing regarding a proposed additional appropriation for the fourth quarter of 2023. The request includes \$2.7 million for the Rainy Day Fund (to cover capital repairs and items normally paid from the Operations Fund) and \$1.7 million for the Education Fund, necessitated by higher-than-anticipated enrollment growth, increased headcount, and payroll adjustments. Mr. Jerome clarified that these appropriations will not increase local tax rates, tax debt, or property tax burdens, and unspent amounts carry over.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** [00:46:05](#) President Williams called for public comment on the additional appropriation. No members of the public spoke.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing closed. The resolution establishing the additional appropriations (\$2.7 million for the Rainy Day Fund and \$1.7 million for the

Education Fund) was subsequently moved, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote** 00:47:42.

00:48:03 Revised and Retired Policy Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board Leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a package of required policy updates, revisions, and retirements compelled by recently enacted Indiana state statutes, vetted through legal counsel.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:49:52.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No members of the general public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period, though board members engaged in dialogue with visiting AP Government students in attendance 00:50:39 regarding local government administration and the function of the Rainy Day Fund 00:51:09.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Upcoming board school visits scheduled for the following morning at Southside and other facilities 00:32:50.
 - Administrative notes regarding recent odor investigations at schools (confirmed as nearby asphalt/propane fumes rather than a gas leak, verified by CenterPoint and air quality checks) 00:34:19.
 - Recognition of Northside's recognition as a Department of Ed "Purple Star School," a robotics grant award benefiting Southside, Central, and state/national competitors, and East Washington Academy's first-place finish in the Spell Bowl division 00:36:06.
 - Reminder of the annual Community Sing event scheduled for December 3rd at 2:45 PM at the Fieldhouse 00:35:52.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially **Adjourned by Voice Vote** 00:52:26.

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